Hanka Goralija

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EDUCATION

École Polytechnique Fédérale de Lausanne **2026 - present**
- PhD in Electrical Engineering
- Advisor: Prof. Volkan Cevher

École Polytechnique Fédérale de Lausanne **2024 - 2026**
- Master's in Robotics
- GPA 5.57/6.0

University of Sarajevo - Faculty of Electrical Engineering Sarajevo **2021 - 2024**
- BSc in Automatic Control and Electronics
- GPA 9.97/10.0 (ranked 1st)

PUBLICATIONS

1. **Hanka Goralija**, Francesco Tonin, Kimon Antonakopoulos, Alp Yurtsever, and Volkan Cevher. **AcceleGrad#: Adaptive Geometry-Aware Acceleration.** ***NeurIPS 2026*** *(Poster)*

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

EPFL **September 2026 - present**
- PhD Researcher @Laboratory for Information and Inference Systems
  - Research on optimization methods for neural network training, including algorithm development, theoretical analysis, and large-scale language model experiments.

EXPERIENCE

EPFL **September 2025 - January 2026**
- Research Assistant @LASA
  - Developed robotics educational material on sampling-based motion planning and graph algorithms for the IEEE RAS-U.

Maxon **July 2025 - September 2025**
- Software Engineer Intern
  - Developed a Python-based automated motor testing framework integrated with TwinCAT.

TEACHING AND MENTORSHIP

Olympiads in Informatics in Bosnia and Herzegovina **August 2021 – present**
- Mentored students preparing for international competitions; team leader at EJOI 2023 and EGOI 2024.

Faculty of Electrical Engineering Sarajevo **October 2022 – February 2024**
- Undergraduate teaching assistant for the courses “Introduction to programming” and “Programming techniques”.

AWARDS AND COMPETITIONS

- Robotics Master Admission Award at EPFL 2024
- Top 100, IEEEXtreme 16.0 programming competition 2022
- Bronze medal, European Girls’ Olympiad in Informatics 2021
- Bronze medal, Iranian Geometry Olympiad. 2019
- International Olympiad in Informatics, National Team Member 2019
- Bronze medal, Junior Balkan Olympiad in Informatics 2017

LANGUAGES

Bosnian (native), English (fluent, TOEFL iBT 101), German (B1)